Template engines

- A template engine in Express.js is used to render dynamic HTML by injecting data into templates.
- Popular engines like EJS, Pug, or Handlebars can be integrated with Express.
- All engines have different syntax similar to HTML, but it helps to pass down dynamic values from express to HTML.
- Set the engine using **app.set('view engine', 'ejs')** and specify the template folder with **app.set('views', './views')**.
- Render templates using **res.render('templateName', { key: value })**.
  - **res.render('index', { title: 'Welcome', message: 'Hello World' });**
- Install the engine using npm (e.g., **npm install ejs**) and create templates with placeholders like **<%= title %>** for data insertion.

Ejs

- We will be using Ejs in this course.
- EJS (Embedded JavaScript) is a simple templating engine for generating dynamic HTML pages.
- It integrates JavaScript logic into HTML using special tags like <%= %>.
- Supports JavaScript features like loops, conditionals, and partials.
- Escapes HTML by default to prevent injection, with options for unescaped output.
- Widely used with Express.js for rendering views dynamically.

Ejs Syntax - Comments

- Add comments in your templates using **<%# ... %>**. These are not included in the output.

```
<%# This is a comment %>
<p>Visible content</p>
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Ejs Syntax – Outputting Values

- Escaped Output (<%= ... %>)
  - Used to print dynamic content, escaping any special HTML characters to prevent injection.

```
// Ejs
<h1><%= title %></h1> <!-- Prints: Welcome -->

// Express
res.render('index', { title: '<Welcome>' });

// Output
<h1>&lt;Welcome&gt;</h1>
```

- Unescaped Output (<%- ... %>)
  - Prints raw HTML without escaping.
  - It's dangerous, make sure to sanitize data before using it.

```
// Ejs
<div><%- content %></div> <!-- Inserts raw HTML -->

// Express
res.render('index', { content: '<strong>Bold Text</strong>' });

// Output
<div><strong>Bold Text</strong></div>
```